

2.6 LABOUR MOBILITY

Multiple Choice Questions

1990/CE/II/09

The ban on the ivory trade in general harms the _____ craftsmen most because of their relatively _____ mobility

- A. younger low occupational
- B. younger high geographical
- C. older low occupational
- D. older high geographical

1991/CE/II/06

Suppose the government provides housing subsidies to teachers serving in the same school for over 10 years. Such a measure will tend to _____ the occupational mobility and _____ the geographical mobility of these teachers.

- A. increase increase
- B. decrease decrease
- C. increase decrease
- D. decrease increase

1992/CE/II/09

Which of the following can increase the occupational mobility of labour?

- A. the development of industries requiring high technology
- B. the setting up of more professional associations
- C. the expansion of vocational training courses
- D. the extension of the Mass Transit Railway network

1993/CE/II/14

Lawyers generally have a low occupational mobility because

- A. they enjoy social status.
- B. they are not skilful in other professions.
- C. they have high opportunity cost in changing jobs.
- D. they are members of the Hong Kong Law Society.

1995/CE/II/21

Which of the following will raise the occupational mobility of labour?

- (1) a higher degree of specialization of skills
 - (2) more information about job vacancies
 - (3) greater power of labour unions
 - (4) provision of retraining programmes
- A. (1) and (2) only
 - B. (1) and (3) only
 - C. (2) and (4) only
 - D. (3) and (4) only

1997/CE/II/14

Which of the following has the least occupational mobility?

- A. lorry driver
- B. salesman
- C. actor
- D. dental surgeon

1999/CE/II/16

Which of the following types of people is more occupationally mobile?

- A. professors in economics in a university
- B. accountants
- C. salesmen
- D. company secretaries

2001/CE/II/14

Suppose the government starts to recruit experienced Putunghua teachers from Mainland China. This would _____ the _____ mobility of experienced Putunghua teachers in Mainland China.

- A. reduce occupational
- B. reduce geographical
- C. increase occupational
- D. increase geographical

2004/CE/II/15

In order to attract more Mainland professionals to work in Hong Kong, some firms plan to provide a housing allowance for them. This would _____ the _____ of these Mainland professionals.

- A. reduce occupational mobility
- B. increase occupational mobility
- C. reduce geographical mobility
- D. increase geographical mobility

2006/CE/II/15

When division of labour is practiced, workers will have a _____ occupational mobility because _____.

- A. higher the labour productivity is raised.
- B. higher the capital goods are used more fully
- C. lower work becomes dull and monotonous
- D. lower workers are only trained for a particular skill

2008/CE/II/15

In which of the following situations will the occupational mobility of labour increase?

- A. improvement in the transportation network
- B. tightened restrictions on obtaining a professional licence
- C. provision of more retraining programmes
- D. raising the legal retirement age

2012/DSE/I/05

The occupational mobility of labour in an economy will increase when

- A. the cross-border railway network is improved.
- B. licences are required for more types of job in the labour market.
- C. tax allowances are provided for continuing education.
- D. there is a greater degree of specialisation in production.

2014/DSE/I/11

Which of the following would most likely increase the occupational mobility of labour in an economy?

- A. The labour unions have stronger bargaining power for the welfare of their members.
- B. The labour department provides tuition fee rebates for participants of retraining programmes.
- C. The transport network is improved by the extension of highways.
- D. The government stops granting funding for an online data system about job vacancies.

2015/DSE/I/04

The _____ mobility of labour will decrease if _____.

- A. geographical the government introduces "city-bike rental scheme" in all train stations.
- B. geographical several big companies set up child care centres in their offices.
- C. occupational the travelling subsidy scheme provided by government is reduced due to a budget deficit
- D. occupational licences are required by the government for more professions

2016/DSE/I/09

Which of the following is the most mobile in terms of occupational mobility?

- A. a professional basketball player
- B. a licensed plumber (水喉匠)
- C. a graduate trainee in a law firm
- D. a clerk in an accounting firm

2017/DSE/I/07

Certain restaurants in China found that they can introduce robots to replace some workers in serving customers without reducing their output. This will

- A. increase the quantity supplied of restaurant workers.
- B. increase the labour productivity of those restaurants.
- C. decrease the geographical mobility of restaurant workers.
- D. decrease the occupational mobility of restaurant workers.

2022/DSE/I/8

The _____ of labour in Hong Kong will increase if _____.

- A. occupational mobility a professional labour union tightens the requirements for entering the industry
- B. occupational mobility the Government waives the examination for foreign-trained doctors to work in Hong Kong
- C. geographical mobility Tuen Ma Line connecting Tuen Mun and Ma On Shan is open
- D. geographical mobility the Government reduces the travel subsidy to the low-income group

2023/DSE/I/07

The occupational mobility of labour of an economy will decrease if

- A. transport subsidies are provided to workers who live in remote districts.
- B. more jobs require specialised skills.
- C. the statutory retirement age is raised from 65 to 70.
- D. more job retraining courses are provided by the government free of charge.

Short & Structured Questions

1991/CE/1/2(a)

(i) Define 'opportunity cost' and 'occupational mobility'. (4 marks)

(ii) In terms of cost, explain why medical doctors in Hong Kong seldom change their occupation. (5 marks)

1993/CE/1/2/(b)(ii)

More and more workers in Hong Kong are shifting from the manufacturing sector to the tertiary sector. State **THREE** problems these workers may face in changing jobs. (6 marks)

2013/DSE/II/11(b)(i)

The government has launched the "Work Incentive Transport Subsidy Scheme", with the following objectives:

- (1) To relieve the burden of travelling expenses commuting to and from work on the part of low-income households with employed members
- (2) To promote sustained employment

Applicants must meet the monthly income and asset limits of the household (e.g. for a single person, the monthly income cannot exceed \$7 300 and the assets cannot exceed \$72 000) and work no less than 72 hours per month in order to apply for a subsidy of \$600 per month.

Discuss the effects of the scheme on labour mobility. (3 marks)

2015/DSE/II/10(c)

Professional football players often retire in their mid-thirties. Although most of them have once been wellpaid as footballers, some of them can only find low-paid jobs after retirement. Explain the above phenomenon in term of labour mobility. (3 marks)

2017/DSE/II/12(a)

Before the British people voted against staying in the European Union (EU), i.e. Brexit, workers from the EU were free to work in Britain and vice versa. Brexit has shocked the economies in Europe and the following table shows some views on Brexit:

British politicians: Low-skilled EU workers should be required to apply for a visa to work in Britain.

Referring to the view of the *British politicians*, explain how labour mobility of the low-skilled workers from the EU would be affected. (3 marks)

2022/DSE/II/2

There are two kinds of food deliverers: 'riders' delivering food by self-provided motorbikes and 'walkers' delivering food on foot. Why do 'riders' usually have a higher income per order than 'walkers'? Suggest ONE demand-side factor and ONE supply-side factor to explain your answer. (4 marks)

The Mainland government introduced the Targeted Poverty Alleviation Campaign (精準扶貧政策) in 2014. After analysing the situations of people living in poverty, the government officials came up with tailor-made measures. The following are two examples of the campaign.

Example 1	A village in Yunnan province has beautiful natural landscape. The government of Yunnan province promoted the village to attract more travellers. Apart from farming, the villagers also set up hostels to serve travellers in order to earn more income.
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(a) Refer to Example 1.

(ii) Explain how labour mobility of the villagers would be affected.

(3 marks)